NEPAL PARICHAYA SERIES · VOLUME III

Nepal Parichaya: Culture & Heritage

UNESCO World Heritage Sites, Linguistic Diversity, and Living Traditions

Cultural & Civic Reference Compendium

Cultural Heritage Edition · 4 Pages

CHAPTER I · PLURALISTIC MOSAIC

Languages, Communities, and Syncretic Harmony

According to the National Population and Housing Census 2078 (2021), Nepal recognizes 142 caste/ethnic groups and 124 mother tongues spanning four major language families: Indo-European, Sino-Tibetan, Austroasiatic (Santhali), and Dravidian (Jhangad/Kurux), alongside the Kusunda language isolate.

Religious coexistence between Hindu, Buddhist, Kirat, Islam, Bon, Prakriti, and Christian traditions manifests in shared sacred sites such as Muktinath, Swoyambhunath, Pathibhara, and Halesi.

CHAPTER II · WORLD HERITAGE

UNESCO Cultural and Natural Sites in Nepal

- Kathmandu Valley Cultural Sites (1979): Seven monument zones—Hanuman Dhoka, Patan, and Bhaktapur Durbar Squares; Pashupatinath; Changunarayan; Swoyambhunath; and Boudhanath.
- Lumbini, the Birthplace of Lord Buddha (1997): Maya Devi Temple, Ashoka Pillar (249 BCE), sacred Puskarini pond, and monastic zone.
- Sagarmatha National Park (1979): High-altitude Sherpa homeland, glaciers, snow leopard habitat, and the worlds highest peak.
- Chitwan National Park (1984): Subtropical Terai riverine grasslands conserving the one-horned rhinoceros, Bengal tiger, and gharial crocodile.

CHAPTER III · NATIONAL EMBLEMS

Constitutional National Symbols

- National Flag: Unique double-pennon crimson flag with deep blue border, lunar crescent, and twelve-rayed sun (Schedule-1, Article 8).
- National Anthem: Sayaun Thunga Phool Ka Hami, penned by Byakul Maila and composed by Amber Gurung.
- National Flower: Lali Gurans (Rhododendron arboreum) · National Bird: Danphe (Himalayan Monal) · National Color: Crimson (Simrik).